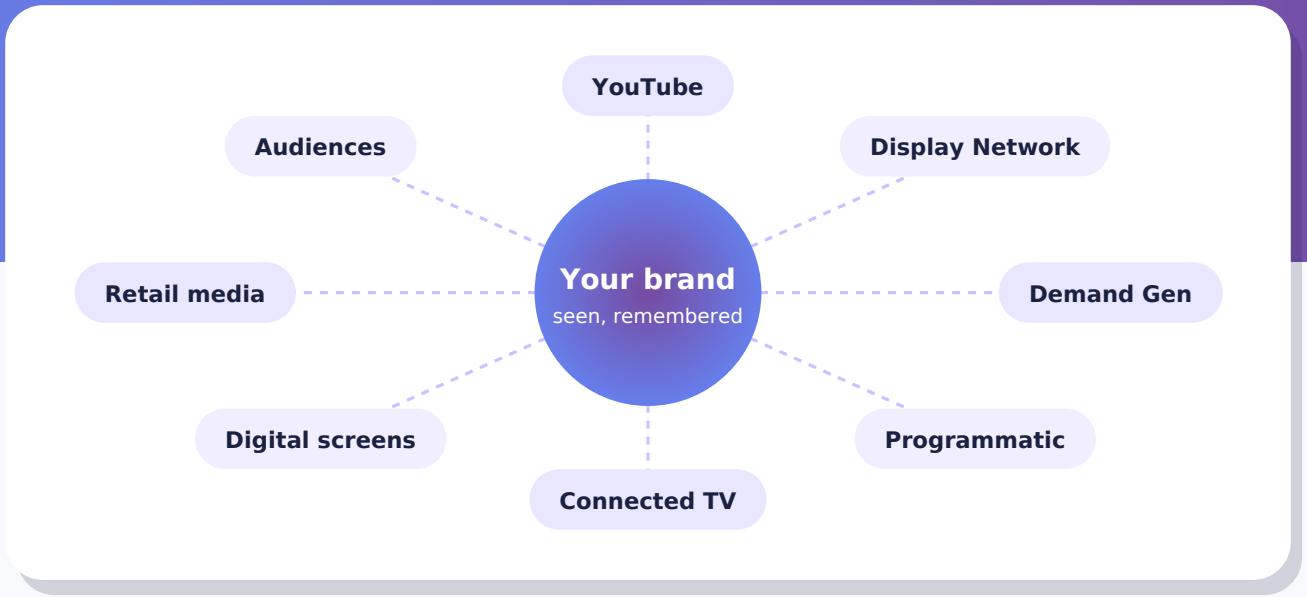
WEEK 9 · DIGITAL MARKETING & AI BOOTCAMP

Display, Video & Programmatic

Awareness advertising on the Google Display Network, YouTube and the open web, explained step by step

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PART A

Foundations

Why awareness advertising matters, the media landscape and the Mauritian market

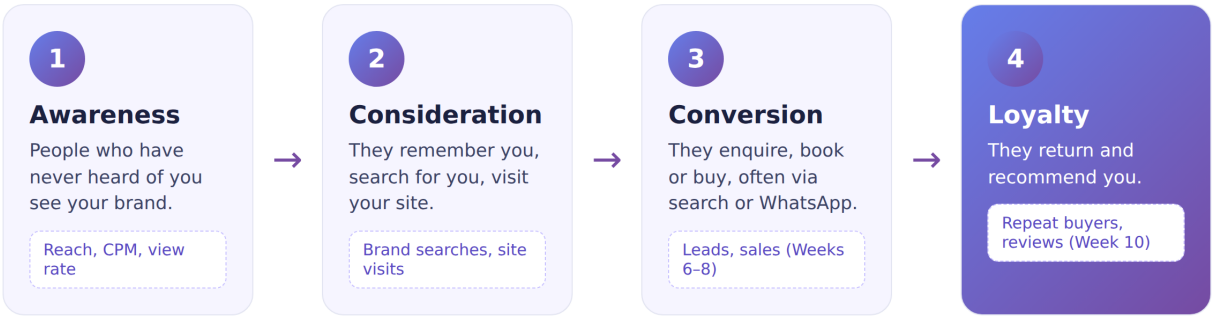
SECTION 1

Awareness advertising and the funnel

Weeks 6 to 8 taught you to capture demand: people who search on Google or respond to a Meta ad. This week is about **creating** demand: making the right people know, remember and like your brand before they are ready to buy. That is the job of display, video and programmatic advertising.

Where display and video fit in the customer journey

Awareness campaigns fill the top of the funnel so that search, social and email have people to convert



Capturing demand vs creating demand

	Capturing demand	Creating demand
Who you reach	People already looking ("cake shop Rose Hill")	People who are not looking yet but could be interested
Typical channels	Search ads (Weeks 6–7), retargeting, Shopping	YouTube, display, Demand Gen, connected TV, digital screens
Main KPIs	Clicks, leads, sales, cost per acquisition	Reach, frequency, views, viewability, brand lift
Time to results	Days	Weeks to months
Risk if you skip it	You miss people ready to buy today	Fewer people search for you tomorrow

In Week 1 you met the customer journey: awareness, consideration, conversion and loyalty. Search can only harvest the demand that already exists. If nobody knows your guesthouse in Trou aux Biches, nobody will type its name into Google. Awareness campaigns fill the top of the funnel so that every other channel has more people to convert.

What "awareness" really means

- **Reach:** the right people see your brand at least once.
- **Memory:** they remember the brand name and what it stands for (recall).
- **Mental availability:** when a need appears ("we need a birthday cake"), your brand comes to mind among the first.
- **Preference:** they like you more than an unknown competitor, so they click your search ad or reply to your WhatsApp message.

> **The mindset:** awareness advertising is not judged by clicks. A YouTube ad that 20,000 people in Mauritius watch to the end can be a success with almost no clicks, if more people search for your brand, visit your page or mention the ad in your shop in the following weeks.

When a business should invest in awareness

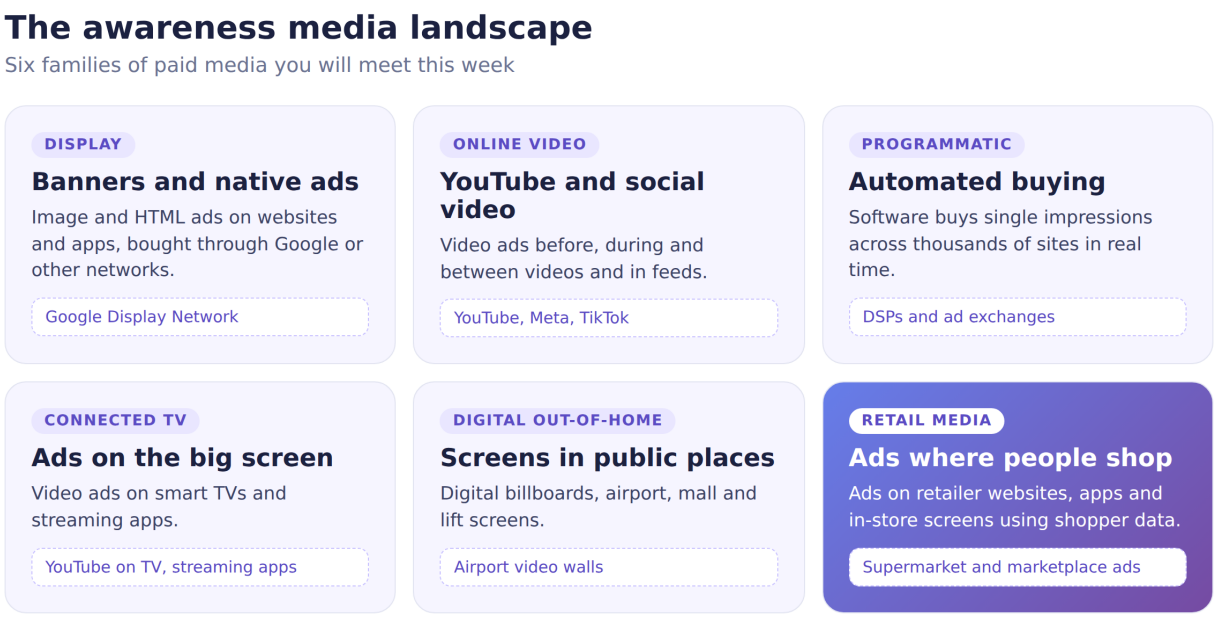
- A **new** business, product, branch or season (a new menu, a new resort opening).
- Search volume for your brand name is **low or flat** (check Google Search Console and Google Trends, Week 3).
- Your search and Meta campaigns have **run out of people** to reach: costs per lead rise and volume stops growing.
- You sell something people **don't search for** because they don't know it exists yet.
- You need to **change perceptions** (repositioning, after a crisis, a new price level).

> Awareness campaigns usually do not pay back in the same week. Agree in advance with the owner or client which metrics will prove success (Section 4), otherwise the campaign will be judged unfairly on clicks and stopped too early.

SECTION 2

Display, video and programmatic: the landscape

Three words are often used together but mean different things. **Display** and **video** describe the ad format. **Programmatic** describes how the ad is bought: automatically, by software, impression by impression.



Display advertising

Display ads are visual ads (images, animations, HTML5) shown on websites and apps, usually in standard spaces called ad units or banners. Common sizes include 300×250 (medium rectangle), 728×90 (leaderboard), 320×50 (mobile banner), 300×600 (half page) and 160×600 (skyscraper). Today most display ads are **responsive**: you upload images, logos and text, and the platform builds the ad to fit each space (Section 11).

Video advertising

Video ads play before, during or after other videos (in-stream), inside feeds (in-feed), between short videos (Shorts, Reels, TikTok) or on TV screens through streaming apps. Video is the strongest awareness format because it combines sight, sound, motion and emotion. YouTube is the largest single video ad platform and is the focus of Part C; Meta and TikTok video are covered in Week 8 and Section 17.

Programmatic advertising

Programmatic means using software to buy and sell ad space automatically. Instead of calling a newspaper and booking a banner for a month, an advertiser uses a platform that bids for individual impressions on thousands of websites, apps and screens in real time. Google Ads display and YouTube campaigns are a simple form of programmatic buying; large advertisers use specialised tools called DSPs (Part D).

Term	Plain-English meaning
Impression	One showing of an ad on a screen
CPM (cost per mille)	The cost of 1,000 impressions
Inventory	The ad space a publisher has to sell
Publisher	The owner of a website, app, channel or screen that shows ads
Ad network	A company that groups many publishers and sells their space (e.g. the Google Display Network)
Open web	Websites and apps outside the big "walled gardens" (Google, Meta, TikTok, Amazon)
Walled garden	A platform that controls its own ads, data and measurement, such as Meta or YouTube

> **Tip:** beginners in Mauritius should start with Google’s own tools (Demand Gen and YouTube video campaigns) and Meta video. They give access to programmatic-style buying with no minimum spend. Specialised DSPs usually require an agency or a large budget.

SECTION 3

Display and video in Mauritius

Mauritius is a small, mobile-first and highly connected market. Awareness media can reach a large share of the population quickly, and costs are usually modest compared with large markets.

Indicator	Figure (DataReportal Digital 2026, data from late 2025)
Population	About 1.27 million
Internet users	About 1.01 million (79.5% of the population)
Social media user identities	About 886,000 (69.9%)
Facebook ad reach	886,000 (69.9%)
Instagram ad reach	418,000 (33.0%, +9.2% in a year)
Mobile connections	2.25 million (178% of the population: many people have two SIMs)
Median fixed internet download speed	57 Mbps (Ookla, August 2025)

The 2026 Mauritius report does not publish a YouTube ad reach figure. Use the audience size estimates inside Google Ads (when you build a campaign) to see how many people your targeting can reach.

Where Mauritians see display and video ads

Channel	Examples	How to buy
YouTube	Music, entertainment, cooking, sport, news and creator channels watched in Mauritius	Google Ads video and Demand Gen campaigns
Local news and media sites	Sites such as lexpress.mu, defimedia.info and lemauricien.com	Direct from the publisher (rate card), or through Google if the site sells its space there
International sites and apps	Weather, games, utilities, global news read by Mauritians	Google Display Network / Demand Gen, programmatic DSPs
Meta and TikTok video	Reels, Stories, in-feed video	Meta Ads Manager (Week 8), TikTok Ads Manager
Digital out-of-home	Digital screens at the airport, in malls and on roadsides	Direct from outdoor media companies
TV and streaming	Local TV channels, streaming apps and YouTube on smart TVs	TV sales houses; YouTube for connected TV

In Mauritius: many local news sites sell banners directly by the week or month, with packages for the homepage and article pages. Ask for their monthly audience (from their own analytics), the ad sizes and whether they can report impressions and clicks. A direct booking guarantees the placement; buying the same site through Google is often cheaper but not guaranteed.

Languages and culture

Most Mauritians move easily between Kreol, French and English. News sites are mainly in French, YouTube viewing mixes all three plus Hindi and Bhojpuri content, and tourists see ads in their own languages. Plan the creative language with the audience: Kreol voice-overs feel close and local, French suits news and premium contexts, English suits B2B and tourists. Avoid literal translations; adapt the message.

Realistic budgets

Because the market is small, a modest budget can reach a large part of a local audience. The table below gives **illustrative** starting budgets for a one-month awareness test; actual costs depend on targeting, season, competition and creative quality. Always start with a test and use your own results as the benchmark.

Business size	Monthly test budget (illustrative)	Typical mix
Small local business (cake shop, gym)	Rs 10,000 – 25,000	YouTube bumper + skippable in one region; Meta video
Medium business (guesthouse, clinic, retailer)	Rs 25,000 – 75,000	Demand Gen + YouTube + one local site booked direct
Large brand (bank, telco, resort group)	Rs 150,000 and more	YouTube reach, programmatic, connected TV, digital out-of-home

PART B

Plan the campaign

Objectives, audiences, placements, budget, frequency and creative strategy for awareness

SECTION 4

Objectives and KPIs for awareness

Every awareness campaign starts with a clear objective written in SMART form (Week 1). The objective decides the campaign type, the bidding, the creative and how you will judge success.

Three awareness objectives

Objective	Question it answers	Main KPIs	Google campaign to use
Reach	How many of the right people saw us?	Unique reach, frequency, CPM	Video reach (efficient reach, non-skippable, target frequency)
Engagement / views	Did people watch and pay attention?	Views, view rate, CPV, watch time, viewability	Video views campaign; Demand Gen
Consideration	Did people become interested and act?	Brand searches, site visits, engaged sessions, channel subscribers	Demand Gen (clicks or conversions), video views

Writing a SMART awareness objective

- **Weak:** "Make more people know Lagon Bleu."
- **SMART:** "Reach 120,000 unique people aged 25–55 in Mauritius and Réunion at least 3 times between 1 and 30 November, with a view rate above 25% on skippable ads, and increase brand-name searches by 20% compared with October."

Set the KPIs before launch

Write a small KPI table in the plan with a target for each metric. Where you have no history, use the first two weeks as a benchmark and set targets for the rest of the campaign. Section 24 explains every formula.

Level	KPI	Example target (illustrative)
Delivery	Impressions, CPM	At least 400,000 impressions at a CPM below Rs 120
Attention	Viewability, view rate, average watch time	Viewability above 70%; view rate above 25%
Reach	Unique reach, average frequency per week	120,000 people; 2–3 times per week
Memory	Ad recall or awareness lift (brand lift study, survey)	Measurable lift in ad recall
Action	Brand searches, direct visits, enquiries	+20% branded searches vs previous month

Tip: add one "business" metric even for pure awareness (bookings, enquiries, footfall). It does not need to be caused only by the campaign, but tracking it keeps the conversation with the client grounded in results.

SECTION 5

Audience strategy: who should see the ads

For awareness you need enough people to make a difference, but not so many that the budget is spread too thin. Start from your personas (Week 4) and translate them into targeting the platforms understand.

From persona to targeting

Persona element	Example	How to target it
Who	Couples 30–55 from Réunion and France planning a holiday	Age, location (Réunion, France), language
Interests	Travel, beaches, diving, food	Affinity segments: beach lovers, travel buffs
Active need	Researching trips to Mauritius right now	In-market: trips to Africa / Indian Ocean; custom segment of searches such as "hotel Trou aux Biches"
What they watch and read	Travel vlogs, diving videos, travel blogs	Topics (Travel), placements (chosen YouTube channels and sites)
Existing relationship	Past guests, website visitors, Instagram followers	Your data segments, customer lists; lookalikes in Demand Gen

Three audience layers

1. **Core audience:** people who match your ideal customer (demographics plus interests or in-market). Most of the budget goes here.
2. **Expansion audience:** lookalikes, broader interests or optimised targeting, to find new people Google predicts will respond.
3. **Warm audience:** website visitors, video viewers and customers, to remind them and move them towards booking. Keep this small in an awareness plan; it belongs mainly to Weeks 6–8.

How big should the audience be?

A rough rule: your audience should be large enough for the budget to reach most of it 2–3 times a week, and small enough that each person sees the ad more than once. In Mauritius, targeting the whole island with very narrow interests can leave only a few thousand people, so test broader segments and let the platform optimise. Google Ads shows an estimated audience size while you build the campaign.

> **In Mauritius:** location targeting matters a lot in a small island. For a local business, choose the districts or a radius around the shop (for example 10 km around Rose Hill). For tourism, target the source markets (Réunion, France, the United Kingdom, South Africa, India) and the language they speak, not Mauritius.

SECTION 6

Placement and channel strategy: where the ads appear

The same ad does not work equally well everywhere. Your placement strategy decides which channels, which types of sites and videos, and which devices you will use, and where you will not appear.

Channel	Best for	Watch out for
YouTube in-stream	Storytelling, sound, high attention, TV-like reach	Skips in the first 5 seconds; you need a strong hook
YouTube Shorts	Younger mobile audiences, vertical creative	Fast swiping; very short attention
YouTube on TV screens	Big-screen impact, shared viewing at home	No clicks; measure reach and lift
Display Network / Demand Gen	Cheap reach, frequency, local news sites	Low-quality apps and sites; check placements
Discover and Gmail	Visual, feed-style ads on mobile	Smaller audiences in some markets
Local site booked direct	Guaranteed premium position, local credibility	Higher price; limited reporting
Digital screens (DOOH)	Mass local visibility in busy places	Hard to measure; short viewing time

Managed vs automatic placements

By default, Google chooses placements automatically, using your audience signals. You can also add **managed placements**: specific websites, apps, YouTube channels or videos where you want your ads to appear. Managed placements give control but limit reach; automatic placements give reach but need regular checking.

A practical placement plan

1. Start broad with good audiences and content exclusions (Section 17).
2. After 7–10 days, open the **Where ads showed** report (placements) and sort by impressions and cost.
3. Exclude placements that are irrelevant, low quality or unsafe for the brand (many mobile game apps, for example).
4. Add strong placements to a managed-placement test campaign.
5. Keep a shared **exclusion list** at account level and reuse it in every campaign.

> **Tip:** test a "YouTube only" and a "display only" version of a campaign with channel controls in Demand Gen. Compare cost per view, viewability and brand searches before choosing your mix.

SECTION 7

Budget, reach and frequency

Awareness budgets are planned around two numbers: how many people you want to reach (reach) and how many times each person should see the ad (frequency).

The basic maths

Formula	Example (illustrative)
Impressions = reach × frequency	60,000 people × 4 times = 240,000 impressions
Budget = impressions ÷ 1,000 × CPM	240,000 ÷ 1,000 × Rs 100 = Rs 24,000
Reach = budget ÷ CPM × 1,000 ÷ frequency	Rs 24,000 ÷ Rs 100 × 1,000 ÷ 4 = 60,000 people
Cost per view (CPV) = cost ÷ views	Rs 24,000 ÷ 48,000 views = Rs 0.50

How often should people see the ad?

One exposure is rarely enough to be remembered; too many exposures annoy people and waste money. Many planners aim for an average of about 2–4 exposures per person per week for a campaign of a few weeks, then adjust using results. Google’s video campaign groups let you set a weekly frequency target between 2 and 7, and Google recommends 3.

Frequency capping

A frequency cap limits how many times the same person sees your ads in a day, week or month. Video reach campaigns with the **target frequency** option aim for a chosen number of exposures per week; other campaign types manage frequency automatically or let you set caps in the campaign settings, depending on the campaign type. Check the **Reach** metrics (unique users, average impression frequency per user) in Google Ads to see what really happened.

Flighting: when to spend

Pattern	How it works	Good for
Continuous	Same budget every day for months	Brands with all-year demand (supermarket, bank)
Flighting (bursts)	Two to four weeks on, then a pause	Seasons, launches, events (school holidays, Divali, Christmas)
Pulsing	Low "always on" level plus bursts at key moments	Most businesses; keeps memory alive between peaks

In Mauritius: plan bursts around local moments: end-of-year festive season and 13th-month bonus, school holidays, Cavadee, Divali, Eid, Chinese Spring Festival, Valentine’s Day and Mother’s Day. For tourism, follow the source markets’ booking seasons (for example European winter) rather than the Mauritian calendar.

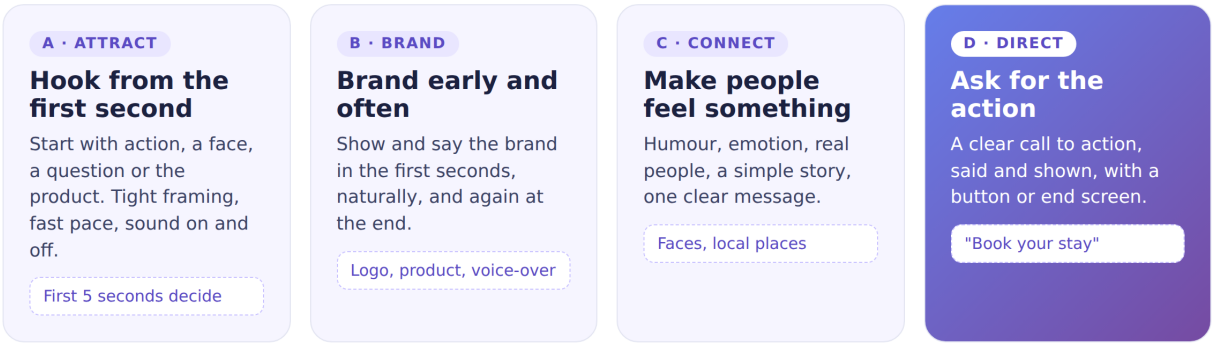
SECTION 8

Creative strategy and the ABCDs of video

In awareness advertising the creative does most of the work. Targeting puts the ad in front of the right people; only the creative makes them stop, watch and remember. Google's ABCD guidelines are a simple checklist for video ads.

The ABCDs of effective YouTube ads

Google's creative guidelines, based on research into thousands of ads



Google reports that ads following the ABCDs were associated with a 30% lift in short-term sales likelihood and a 17% lift in long-term brand contribution (Google/Kantar study of about 11,000 ads, 2021).

One big idea, three creative variations

Your Week 9 deliverable asks for **3 creative variations**. Variations are not three different campaigns: they share one message and one brand idea, but change one thing at a time so you can learn what works.

Variation	What changes	Example for Lagon Bleu guesthouse
A · Emotion	Story and feeling	"Your morning in Trou aux Biches": sunrise swim, breakfast on the terrace, host greeting by name
B · Product / proof	Facts and benefits	"3 reasons guests come back": 50 m from the beach, home-cooked creole dinners, 4.8 rating
C · Offer / urgency	A reason to act now	"Stay 7 nights, pay 6 until 15 December" with dates on screen

Adapt each variation to the formats

- **6-second bumper:** one idea, brand in the first 2 seconds, one strong image (the cut-down of each variation).
- **15–30-second video:** hook, story, brand, call to action.
- **Vertical 9:16 version** for Shorts, Reels and TikTok, with captions.
- **Images** in 1.91:1, 1:1 and 4:5 for Demand Gen and display, using the same key visual and headline.

> **Tip:** AI tools (Week 13) can resize images, write headline options and create first drafts of storyboards. Always check the result for brand accuracy and local relevance, and never show fake customers or invented reviews.

SECTION 9

Designing display ads that work

Display ads are seen for a second or two, often while people are reading something else. Good display creative is simple, bold and instantly recognisable.

Seven rules for display creative

1. **One message per ad:** one benefit or one offer, not a list.
2. **Brand clearly visible:** logo and brand colours in every size.
3. **Strong image:** one person, product or place, high quality, with clear focus.
4. **Little text:** a short headline that can be read in two seconds.
5. **Clear call to action:** "Discover", "Book now", "See the menu".
6. **Contrast:** ads must stand out from white news pages and dark apps.
7. **Consistency:** same visual idea as your video and social posts, so each exposure builds the same memory.

Image ad checklist

Check	Why
No text covering more than a small part of the image	Responsive ads crop images; text may be cut
Key subject in the centre of the image	Square and landscape crops keep the centre
No fake buttons or misleading claims	Against Google Ads policies; ads may be disapproved
High resolution (see Section 11)	Blurry ads look cheap and lose trust
Logo on a clean or transparent background	Logos are shown small and must stay readable

Static, animated and HTML5 ads

Most advertisers now use responsive display ads. You can still upload your own fixed-size image ads (for example 300×250) or HTML5 animations built in tools such as Google Web Designer, but you need many sizes and they do not adapt automatically. For local news sites booked directly, ask the publisher which sizes and file formats they accept.

PART C

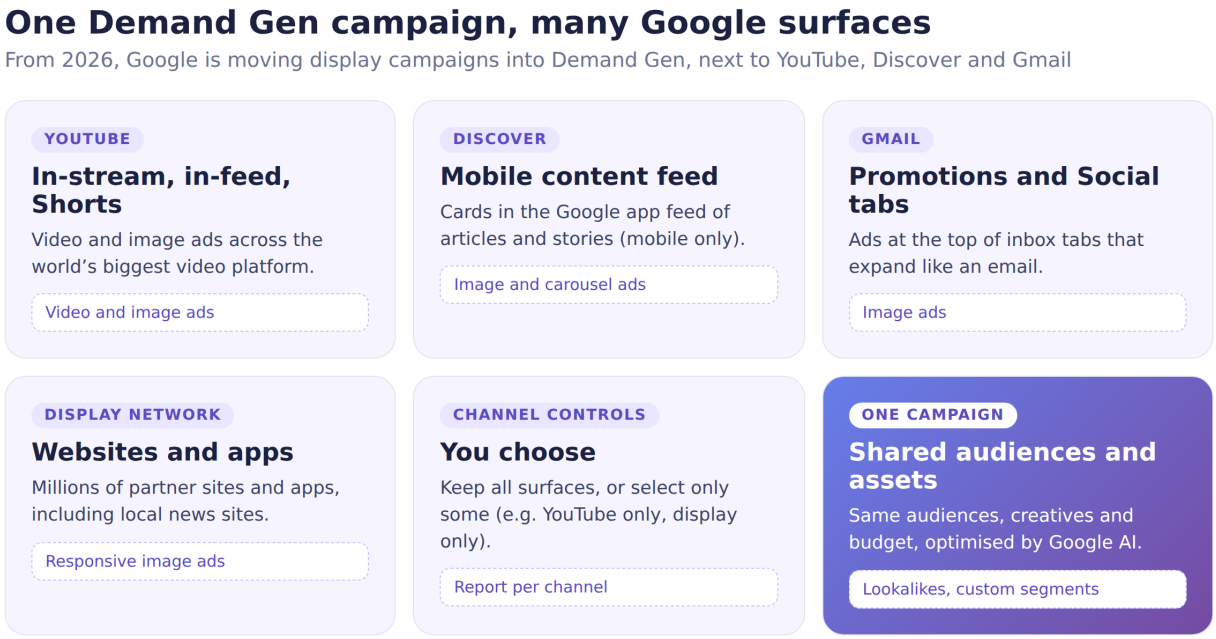
Google display & YouTube

Demand Gen, responsive display ads, YouTube formats, video campaigns and targeting, step by step

SECTION 10

The Google Display Network and Demand Gen

The Google Display Network (GDN) is a group of millions of websites, apps and Google-owned properties where Google can show image and video ads. In 2026 the way you buy it is changing: Google is moving display campaigns into **Demand Gen**.



What changed in 2025–2026

Date	Change
March 2025	Channel controls extended to every Demand Gen surface (YouTube, Discover, Gmail, Display Network)
April 2025	New Video action campaigns could no longer be created; from July 2025 existing ones were upgraded to Demand Gen
November 2025	Brand suitability settings unified across YouTube feeds, Discover and the Display Network
By April 2026	Remaining Video action campaigns automatically upgraded to Demand Gen
From June 2026	Migration tool to move standalone Display campaigns into Demand Gen; creating new standalone Display campaigns will later stop; migration continues into 2027

Sources: Google Ads Help, "Video Action Campaigns are being upgraded to Demand Gen"; Search Engine Journal, 26 May 2026.

What this means for you

- The **display inventory does not disappear**: you can still run ads only on the Display Network, but you build them as a Demand Gen campaign with channel controls set to Display.
- If you manage older Display campaigns, they stay editable until they are migrated; plan your migration and test before Google does it automatically.

- Check that **placement exclusions**, app exclusions and content settings carry over correctly after migration.
- Demand Gen brings features standard Display did not have: carousel ads, lookalike segments, channel-level reporting and generative AI image tools.
- Some Google Ads screens, help pages and older tutorials still show "Display campaign": you will meet both names for a while.

Demand Gen in one paragraph

Demand Gen is a Google Ads campaign type designed to reach people while they browse and watch (rather than search) and drive them to act. One campaign can show image, carousel and video ads on YouTube (in-stream, in-feed, Shorts), Discover, Gmail and the Display Network. Google AI decides where and to whom to show each ad, guided by your audiences, assets, bidding goal and channel controls.

SECTION 11

Responsive display ads and image specifications

A responsive display ad (RDA) is a set of assets (images, logos, headlines, descriptions and optionally videos) that Google combines automatically to fit any ad space. Demand Gen image ads work in a similar way.

Assets for a responsive display ad

Asset	Specification (Google Ads Help, October 2026)
Landscape image (1.91:1)	Recommended 1200 × 628 px; minimum 600 × 314 px; max 5,120 KB
Square image (1:1)	Recommended 1200 × 1200 px; minimum 300 × 300 px; max 5,120 KB
Square logo (1:1)	Recommended 1200 × 1200 px; minimum 128 × 128 px
Landscape logo (4:1)	Recommended 1200 × 300 px; minimum 512 × 128 px
Short headlines	1 to 5, each up to 30 characters
Long headline	1, up to 90 characters
Descriptions	1 to 5 (each up to 90 characters)
Business name	Your brand name as customers know it
Videos (optional)	YouTube links; shown where video is possible

Demand Gen also uses portrait images (4:5, for example 960 × 1200 px) for feeds such as Discover and YouTube Shorts. Upload all three ratios (1.91:1, 1:1, 4:5) to give the system the most placements.

Writing the text assets

Asset	Good example (Lakaz Gato cake shop)	Why
Short headline	Custom cakes in Rose Hill	Product and place in 25 characters
Short headline	Order on WhatsApp today	Clear action
Long headline	Birthday and wedding cakes made by hand in Rose Hill, delivered across Plaines Wilhems	Full message for larger spaces
Description	Choose your flavour, size and design. Free tasting for wedding orders.	Benefit plus reason to act

> **Tip:** check the **ad strength** indicator and the previews while you build the ad. Each headline must make sense alone, because Google may show any headline with any image.

SECTION 12

Creating a Demand Gen campaign step by step

This is the setup for an awareness-and-consideration campaign in Google Ads. Menus change often, so if a label differs slightly, look for the closest option. Week 6 covers account setup, billing and conversion tracking.

1. In Google Ads, click **+ Create → Campaign**.
2. Choose an objective such as **Website traffic** or **Awareness and consideration** (or create a campaign without an objective), then select **Demand Gen**.
3. Name the campaign clearly: *LagonBleu_DG_Awareness_FR-RE_Nov26*.
4. Choose the **bidding goal**: for awareness and traffic, **clicks** (maximise clicks or a target cost per click); if conversions are tracked and you have enough data, conversions.
5. Set the **budget** (daily or campaign total) and the **start and end dates**.
6. Create the first **ad group**: locations, languages and the **audience** (your segments, custom segments, lookalikes, interests).
7. Set **channel controls**: all Google channels, or only selected ones (for example YouTube and Display).
8. Create the **ads**: image, carousel or video ads, with your assets, final URL (with UTM parameters, Week 2) and call to action.
9. Review **brand suitability** and exclusions (Section 17) and publish.
10. Wait for the learning period (usually a couple of weeks) before making big changes.

Recommended structure for a small awareness campaign

Level	Setup
Campaign	One Demand Gen campaign per market and goal (e.g. Mauritius locals, or tourists from Réunion)
Ad groups	2–3 ad groups by audience: core interests, custom segment, lookalike of past customers
Ads	The 3 creative variations in each ad group (video + image versions)
Channels	Start with all channels; review the channel report after 2 weeks

Demand Gen works best with enough budget to learn. Google suggests budgets linked to your target cost per result; with very small daily budgets (a few hundred rupees), results can be unstable. For tiny budgets, a Video reach campaign with a fixed CPM goal is often more predictable for pure awareness.

SECTION 13

YouTube ad formats

YouTube offers several ad formats, each with its own length, position and way of paying. Choosing the right one depends on your objective and the creative you have.

YouTube ad formats at a glance

Lengths and billing as described in Google Ads Help, October 2026

SKIPPABLE IN-STREAM

Skip after 5 seconds

Before, during or after videos. No maximum length; under 3 minutes recommended.

Pay per view (30 s or full ad) or per 1,000 impressions

NON-SKIPPABLE IN-STREAM

Must be watched

15 or 20 seconds depending on region; up to 30 seconds on TV screens.

Pay per 1,000 impressions

BUMPER

Up to 6 seconds

Short, non-skippable, ideal for reach and reminders.

Pay per 1,000 impressions

IN-FEED

In search and feeds

Thumbnail plus text in YouTube search results, Home and Watch Next.

Pay when someone clicks to watch

SHORTS

Between Shorts

Vertical video (or image) ads, swipeable at any time. Under 60 seconds recommended.

View at 10 s, end, or interaction

MASTHEAD

Top of YouTube Home

Premium reservation format for big launches, bought via a Google representative.

Fixed CPM or cost per hour

How you pay

Model	You pay for	Used with
CPV (cost per view)	A view: on skippable ads, when someone watches 30 seconds (or the whole ad if shorter) or interacts; on Shorts, 10 seconds, the end or an interaction	Skippable in-stream, Shorts, video views campaigns
CPM / target CPM	1,000 impressions	Bumpers, non-skippable ads, Video reach campaigns
Click to watch	A click on an in-feed thumbnail (or 10 seconds of autoplay in video views campaigns)	In-feed ads
Conversion-based bidding	An impression, optimised towards conversions	Demand Gen and conversion-focused campaigns

Which format for which job

Job	Best format	Why
Reach as many people as possible cheaply	Bumper + skippable (efficient reach)	Low CPM, high reach
Tell a full story	Skippable 30–60 s, or non-skippable 15–20 s	Time to build emotion
Remind and repeat	Bumpers	6 seconds, easy to repeat without annoying
Grow channel views and subscribers	In-feed	People choose to watch
Reach young mobile viewers	Shorts (vertical)	Native to the Shorts feed
Big national launch in one day	Masthead (reservation)	Top of YouTube Home; sold by Google sales teams in selected markets

Overlay ads (banners over videos) were discontinued in April 2023, so you will not find them in Google Ads any more. Ad pods (two ads in a row) and mid-roll ads in long videos are decided by YouTube and creators, not by the advertiser.

SECTION 14

YouTube video campaign types

When you create a video campaign in Google Ads you choose a campaign subtype. Each subtype optimises for a different result and uses a different set of formats.

Subtype	Optimises for	Formats	Bidding
Video reach: efficient reach	Most unique people for the budget	Bumper, skippable (plus in-feed and Shorts with multi-format ads)	Target CPM
Video reach: non-skippable reach (beta)	Full message seen	15-second and 30-second (mainly TV) non-skippable, or bumper + 15 s mix	Target CPM
Video reach: target frequency	The same people a set number of times per week or month	Bumper, skippable, non-skippable, in-feed, Shorts	Target CPM
Video views	Views and engagement	Skippable in-stream, in-feed, Shorts	Cost-per-view bidding
Ad sequence	Telling a story in a set order	Several videos shown to the same person in sequence	Target CPM or CPV
Demand Gen (video)	Clicks and conversions	Video and image across YouTube and Google feeds	Clicks or conversion bidding

Sources: Google Ads Help, "Video reach campaigns" and "Video campaign groups", October 2026. Names and options are updated regularly.

Video campaign groups

If you run several YouTube campaigns at the same time (for example a reach campaign and a views campaign), a **video campaign group** lets Google manage reach and frequency across them: either to maximise unique reach for the whole group, or to hit a weekly frequency target between 2 and 7 (Google recommends 3).

Ad sequencing: telling a story

An ad sequence shows ads in a chosen order to the same person: for example a 6-second teaser, then a 20-second story, then a 6-second offer reminder. It is useful for launches and for the three creative variations of your deliverable (Section 29).

> **In Mauritius:** for most local awareness campaigns, a **Video reach – efficient reach** campaign with a bumper and a 15–30-second skippable ad is the simplest and most cost-effective start. Add a video views campaign later if you want to grow your YouTube channel.

SECTION 15

Setting up a YouTube campaign step by step

Before you start, upload your videos to the brand's YouTube channel (public or unlisted) and link the channel to Google Ads (Tools → Data manager → YouTube).

1. Click **+ Create → Campaign** and choose **Awareness and consideration** (or no objective).
2. Select the **Video** campaign type and the subtype: **Video reach** (then efficient reach, non-skippable reach or target frequency) or **Video views**.
3. Name the campaign, set the **budget** (daily or total for the campaign) and **dates**.
4. Choose **bidding**: target CPM for reach, a cost-per-view goal for views.
5. Set **networks** (YouTube; Google video partners on or off), **locations** and **languages**.
6. Review **content suitability** (inventory type and exclusions) and, if available, a **frequency** setting.
7. Create the **ad group**: demographics, audience segments and, if needed, content targeting (topics, keywords, placements).
8. Create the **video ad**: paste the YouTube link, add the final URL (with UTM parameters), display URL, call to action (up to 10 characters is typical) and headline; add a companion banner if offered.
9. Check previews on mobile, computer and TV, then publish.
10. After 3–5 days, check delivery, view rate and placements; after 2 weeks, optimise (Section 27).

Video specs to prepare

Item	Recommendation
Orientation	Horizontal 16:9 for in-stream and TV; vertical 9:16 for Shorts; square 1:1 works in feeds
Resolution	At least 1080p (1920 × 1080 or 1080 × 1920)
Bumper length	6 seconds or less
Skippable length	15–60 seconds is common; under 3 minutes recommended
Sound	Clear voice-over and music, but also subtitles: many people watch on mute
End screen	Logo, offer and call to action for the last 3–5 seconds

> **Tip:** create one master video, then edit cut-downs: a 6-second bumper, a 15-second version and a vertical version. This is cheaper than shooting three times and keeps the brand consistent.

SECTION 16

Audience targeting in Google Ads

Audience targeting reaches people based on who they are, what they are interested in, what they are researching and how they have interacted with your business. Google calls these **audience segments**.

Two ways to find your audience

Target the person, or target the content they are reading or watching

WHO · AUDIENCES

Target people

- Affinity: long-term interests and habits
- In-market: actively researching a purchase
- Life events: moving, marriage, graduation
- Detailed demographics: parents, homeowners
- Custom segments: built from keywords, URLs, apps
- Your data: site visitors, customers, YouTube viewers
- Lookalikes (Demand Gen): people similar to your lists

WHERE · CONTEXT

Target content

- Topics: pages and videos about a subject
- Keywords: content that matches your words
- Placements: specific sites, apps, channels, videos
- Content exclusions: themes you never want to appear next to
- Inventory type: Expanded, Standard, Limited
- Works without cookies or personal data
- Ideal for brand safety and local relevance

Segment type	What it is	Awareness example
Affinity	Long-term interests and lifestyles	Beach lovers, food lovers, fitness enthusiasts
In-market	People actively researching a product or service	Trips to the Indian Ocean, wedding services
Life events	Major moments: moving, marriage, graduation, new baby	Getting married soon (wedding cakes)
Detailed demographics	Parental status, education, homeownership and more	Parents of young children (kids' parties)
Custom segments	Built by you from keywords people search, URLs of sites they visit and apps they use	Searches "hotel Mauritius", visits to travel forums
Your data	Website visitors, app users, YouTube viewers, customer lists (formerly "remarketing")	People who watched 50% of your video
Lookalike segments	In Demand Gen: people similar to a list you provide	Lookalike of past guests
Optimised targeting	Google finds more people likely to respond, beyond your segments	Turned on by default in many campaigns

Building a custom segment

1. Go to **Tools → Shared library → Audience manager → Custom segments** (or create it while building the ad group).
2. Choose "People with any of these interests or purchase intentions" and add 10–20 keywords (e.g. "hotel Trou aux Biches", "Mauritius guesthouse", "diving Mauritius").
3. Or choose "People who searched for any of these terms on Google" to target recent searchers.
4. Add URLs of websites your audience visits (competitors, travel blogs) and apps they use.
5. Save, then check the estimated audience size.

Using your own data (first-party data)

Your own data is the most valuable audience, especially as privacy rules tighten (Section 22). Build segments from website visitors (via the Google tag, Week 2), YouTube channel viewers and subscribers, and customer lists uploaded with consent (Customer Match, subject to Google's eligibility rules). Use them to exclude existing customers from awareness campaigns, or as the seed for lookalikes.

> Under the Mauritius Data Protection Act 2017, you need a lawful basis (usually consent) to use customers' personal data for advertising. Only upload lists of people who agreed to receive marketing, and say in your privacy notice that you use advertising partners.

SECTION 17

Contextual targeting, placements and exclusions

Contextual targeting shows your ads next to content about a subject, regardless of who the viewer is. It does not need cookies or personal data, which makes it more important every year.

Method	How it works	Example
Topics	Pages and videos about a subject in Google's list of topics	Travel → Beaches and islands
Keywords (content)	Pages and videos related to your words	"snorkelling", "honeymoon ideas"
Placements	Specific websites, apps, YouTube channels or videos	A popular Mauritian cooking channel
Combined	Audience AND topic together (narrower)	Parents watching family-cooking videos

Content targeting is fully available in Video campaigns. Demand Gen relies mainly on audiences, with exclusions and some content controls; check the current options in your account.

Exclusions and brand suitability

Exclusions protect your brand and your budget. Set them at **account level** (so every campaign uses them) and add campaign-level exclusions when needed.

Setting	What to do
Inventory type	Choose Expanded, Standard (recommended) or Limited. Limited excludes more sensitive content, at the cost of some reach.
Excluded content types and labels	For example live streams, embedded videos, or content rated for mature audiences
Excluded topics and keywords	Tragedy and conflict, sensitive social issues, or anything that clashes with your brand
Placement exclusion list	Low-quality apps, irrelevant channels, sites with poor viewability; reuse the list everywhere
Excluded audiences	Existing customers (if the goal is new reach), employees, job seekers

> **Tip:** check the "Where ads showed" report every week during the first month. Children's channels, game apps and auto-generated video channels can absorb budget quickly with little value for most advertisers.

SECTION 18

Video and display beyond Google

Google is not the only place to run awareness campaigns. Most plans in Mauritius combine YouTube with Meta, and sometimes TikTok, LinkedIn or a local website.

Platform	Awareness options	Best for in Mauritius
Meta (Facebook, Instagram)	Awareness objective (reach, ad recall), video views (ThruPlay), Reels and Stories ads	The widest local reach; all ages; Kreol and French video (Week 8)
TikTok	Reach and video views objectives; in-feed ads; Spark Ads boost organic posts	Under-35s, trends, entertainment, food and events
LinkedIn	Brand awareness objective; video, document and image ads	B2B, recruitment, training, professional services
Local news sites (direct)	Homepage and article banners, sponsored articles, newsletters	Credibility, older and news-reading audiences
Programmatic DSP (via agency)	Open web, premium deals, connected TV, audio	Large brands, tourism campaigns in source markets

One message, many platforms

Use the same creative idea everywhere, adapted to each format: 16:9 for YouTube in-stream, 9:16 for Shorts, Reels and TikTok, 1:1 or 4:5 for feeds. Compare platforms with the same metrics (CPM, cost per thousand people reached, cost per completed view, viewability) rather than each platform’s favourite metric.

> **In Mauritius:** for a local business, a typical starting mix is about two-thirds of the budget on Meta and YouTube video, and the rest on Demand Gen or a direct booking with a local news site. Adjust after the first month based on cost per thousand people reached and brand searches.

PART D

Programmatic explained

How automated ad buying works:
ad tech, deals, data, privacy
and the new screens (theory)

SECTION 19

What programmatic advertising is

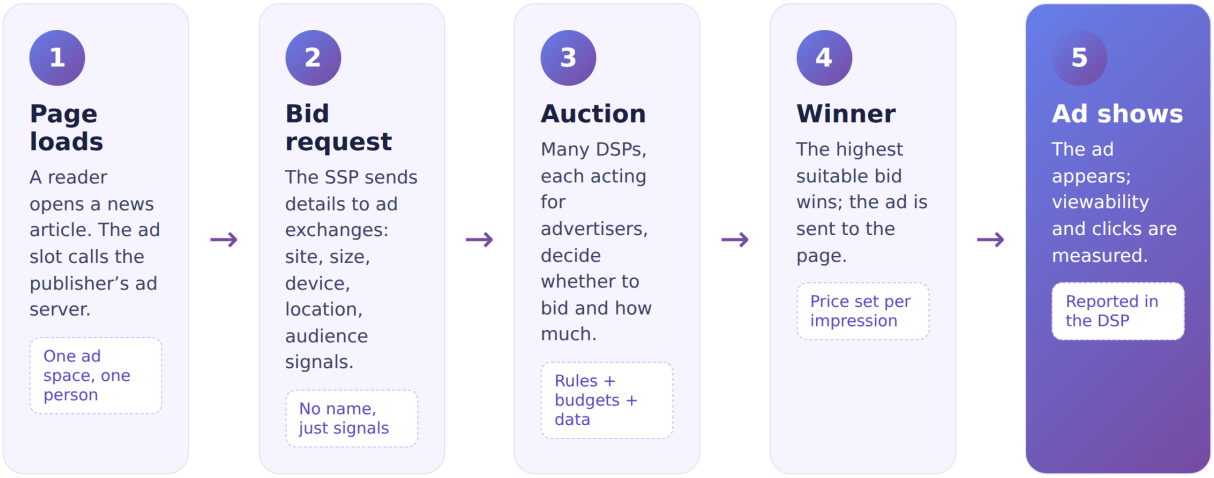
Programmatic advertising is the automated buying and selling of ad space using software and data. This part is **theory**: you will rarely buy programmatically yourself as a beginner, but you need to understand the words, the players and the risks to talk with agencies and clients.

Before and after programmatic

	Traditional (direct) buying	Programmatic buying
How	Call or email the publisher, negotiate, sign an insertion order, send the banner	Set rules in a platform; software buys impressions automatically
What you buy	A position for a period (homepage banner for a week)	Individual impressions, one by one
Targeting	The site's audience in general	The site plus the person's context, device, location and audience signals
Scale	One publisher at a time	Thousands of sites, apps and screens at once
Optimisation	At the end of the campaign	Continuously, every day

Real-time bidding: what happens when a page loads

The whole auction takes a fraction of a second, millions of times a day



Real-time bidding (RTB) in plain English

Imagine every single ad space on every page view being sold in a tiny auction. When someone opens an article, the website sends a description of that ad opportunity (site, page topic, ad size, device, approximate location, and sometimes audience signals) to one or more ad exchanges. Software acting for advertisers decides in a fraction of a second whether this impression is worth buying and how much to bid. The winning ad is shown. This happens billions of times a day around the world.

Programmatic is not only RTB

RTB in the open auction is the best-known form, but programmatic also includes private deals and guaranteed buys (Section 21). The common point is automation: the same software handles targeting, delivery, frequency, reporting and billing.

> **Analogy:** traditional buying is like renting a billboard for a month. Programmatic is like a taxi app: the system matches each request (an ad space) with the best available offer (an advertiser) in real time, at a price set by demand at that moment.

SECTION 20

The ad tech chain: DSPs, SSPs and exchanges

Between the advertiser and the publisher sit several technology platforms. Each one takes a share of the money, so understanding the chain helps you ask the right questions about cost and transparency.

Who is who in programmatic

The buy side works for advertisers; the sell side works for publishers

BUY SIDE

Advertiser and agency

Set goals, audiences, budgets and creatives.

A hotel group, its media agency

BUY SIDE

DSP (demand-side platform)

Software that buys impressions across many exchanges in one place.

Display & Video 360, The Trade Desk

MIDDLE

Ad exchange

The marketplace where auctions take place.

Google Ad Manager's exchange and others

SELL SIDE

SSP (supply-side platform)

Software that sells a publisher's ad space to many buyers.

Google Ad Manager, Magnite, PubMatic

SELL SIDE

Publisher

Owns the website, app or screen with the audience.

A news site, an app, a streaming service

ALL ALONG

Data and verification

Data partners, measurement and brand-safety tools.

IAS, DoubleVerify, consent platforms

Player	Role	Examples
DSP (demand-side platform)	Lets advertisers and agencies buy impressions from many exchanges, with targeting, bidding and reporting	Google Display & Video 360, The Trade Desk, Amazon DSP
SSP (supply-side platform)	Lets publishers sell impressions to many buyers and get the best price	Google Ad Manager, Magnite, PubMatic
Ad exchange	The marketplace where bids from DSPs meet impressions from SSPs	Often part of an SSP
Ad server	Stores the ads, decides which one to show, counts impressions and clicks	Google Campaign Manager 360, Google Ad Manager
Ad network	Groups publishers and sells their inventory as a package	Google Display Network
Data and verification	Audience data, measurement, brand safety, fraud detection	Integral Ad Science (IAS), DoubleVerify

Where does the money go?

Out of every rupee an advertiser spends programmatically, part goes to the publisher and part is taken by the platforms and services in between (DSP fees, SSP fees, data, verification, agency fees). The part lost between advertiser and publisher is sometimes called the **ad tech tax**. Industry studies have found that this share can be large and that part of it is hard to trace. Good practice is to ask for transparent fees and to buy through fewer, trusted paths (**supply path optimisation**).

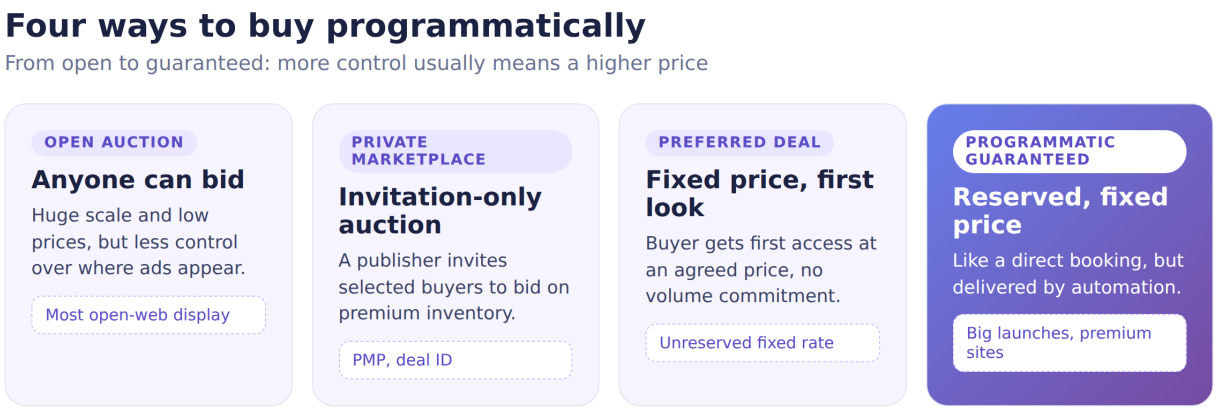
Questions to ask an agency running programmatic for you

1. Which DSP do you use, and what is the total fee (platform, data, agency)?
2. Can we see a placement report (sites and apps where ads appeared)?
3. What viewability, invalid-traffic and brand-safety measurement do you use?
4. Do you use private deals or only the open auction?
5. How is frequency managed across channels?
6. Which results will you report, and how will you prove incremental impact?

SECTION 21

Buying models: open auction to programmatic guaranteed

Programmatic inventory can be bought in four main ways. The Interactive Advertising Bureau (IAB), the industry body that sets advertising standards, uses the names below.



Model	IAB description (summarised)	Price	Guaranteed?
Open auction (open exchange)	Publishers offer impressions to any and all buyers	Auction, usually lowest	No
Private marketplace (invitation-only auction)	Publishers offer impressions to a selected group of buyers, usually at higher rates	Auction with a floor price	No
Preferred deal (unreserved fixed rate)	Buyers pay a fixed rate for impressions that would otherwise go to auction, without reserving them	Fixed	No
Programmatic guaranteed (automated guaranteed)	Price and volume agreed between publisher and advertiser; the space is reserved	Fixed	Yes

A **deal ID** is the code that connects a private deal agreed with a publisher to the buyer's DSP. When the publisher has an impression that matches the deal, it is offered to that buyer first.

Choosing a model

- **Open auction:** large reach at low cost; needs strong brand-safety controls and placement checks.
- **Private marketplace:** premium sites and better context; useful for brands that care about where they appear.
- **Preferred deal:** first access to a publisher's inventory at a known price, without committing to volume.
- **Programmatic guaranteed:** big launches and sponsorships when you must appear on a specific site on specific days.

> **In Mauritius:** local publishers mostly sell directly (a rate card and a booking), which works like a non-automated guaranteed buy. Tourism brands often use programmatic deals in their source markets (France, Réunion, the United Kingdom, South Africa) through agencies, with premium travel and news sites.

SECTION 22

Data, cookies and privacy

Programmatic advertising depends on data to decide which impressions to buy. Privacy laws and browser changes have changed what data can be used, and the situation in 2026 is different from what was predicted a few years ago.

Types of data

Type	What it is	Example
First-party data	Data you collect directly with consent	Website visitors, customers, email subscribers
Second-party data	Another company's first-party data shared with you through a partnership	An airline shares an audience with a hotel
Third-party data	Data bought from providers who collect it across many sites	Interest segments sold in a DSP
Contextual data	Information about the page or video, not the person	An article about diving in Mauritius

DMPs and CDPs

Tool	What it does	Main data
DMP (data management platform)	Collects and organises mostly anonymous audience data (cookies, device IDs) to build segments for advertising	Third-party and anonymous data; shrinking in importance
CDP (customer data platform)	Combines known customer data (CRM, website, app, email, purchases) into one profile per customer	First-party data; growing in importance (Week 15)

Cookies and privacy: the situation in 2026

- A **cookie** is a small file a website stores in the browser. **Third-party cookies** are set by a domain other than the site you visit (for example an ad platform), and have long been used to follow people across sites.
- **Safari and Firefox** block third-party cookies by default, and Apple requires apps to ask permission before tracking users across other companies' apps (App Tracking Transparency).

- **Chrome** did not remove third-party cookies after all: in April 2025 Google said it would keep its current approach to third-party cookie choice, and in October 2025 it announced it was retiring the Privacy Sandbox technologies because of low adoption.
- Even so, signals are weaker than before: many users decline tracking, ad blockers are common, and laws require consent.
- **Consent** matters: the EU and UK (GDPR) and Mauritius (Data Protection Act 2017) require a lawful basis for processing personal data. Google requires Consent Mode for measurement and personalised ads for users in the European Economic Area and the UK, which matters for tourism advertisers targeting Europe.

What smart advertisers do now

- Build **first-party data** with consent (newsletter, WhatsApp opt-ins, loyalty, bookings).
- Use **contextual targeting** more (Section 17).
- Rely on platforms' **modelled** measurement and on tests (Section 25) rather than tracking every individual.
- Install tags properly with a consent banner (Week 2) so that data you collect is lawful and usable.

SECTION 23

New screens: connected TV, digital out-of-home, retail media and audio

Programmatic buying now reaches screens far beyond websites. These channels are mostly used by larger advertisers, but they are growing quickly and you should know how they work.

Channel	What it is	How it is bought	Measured by
CTV (connected TV)	Video ads on internet-connected TVs: YouTube on TV, streaming apps, smart TV platforms	YouTube campaigns (TV screens device), DSPs, streaming services	Reach, completion rate, co-viewing estimates, brand lift
OTT (over-the-top)	Streaming video delivered over the internet rather than cable or satellite, on any device	Same as CTV	Completed views
DOOH (digital out-of-home)	Digital billboards and screens in airports, malls, lifts, roadsides	Direct with outdoor media owners, or programmatically in some markets	Estimated audience (footfall, traffic), plays
Retail media	Ads on retailers' websites, apps and in-store screens, using shopper data	Retailer's own ad platform (e.g. Amazon Ads) or sales team	Sales at the retailer (closed loop)
Digital audio	Ads in music streaming and podcasts	Platforms such as Spotify Ads; podcast sponsorships	Listens, completion, reach

Connected TV and YouTube

More and more YouTube is watched on TV screens. In Google Ads you can see and adjust performance by device, including TV screens. TV-screen ads cannot be clicked, so judge them by reach, completion and brand lift, not clicks. Non-skippable 30-second ads are available on TV screens, which makes YouTube a way to reuse a classic TV commercial.

Digital out-of-home in Mauritius

Mauritius has a growing number of digital screens, for example large video walls in the arrival and baggage halls of Sir Seewoosagur Ramgoolam International Airport operated by Times OOH Mauritius, plus screens in shopping malls and on major roads. They are bought directly from media owners. Combine them with mobile and YouTube ads in the same area and period to strengthen memory.

Retail media

Retail media lets brands advertise where people shop, using the retailer’s own purchase data, and measure sales at that retailer. It is huge in the US and Europe (Amazon, Walmart, supermarkets). In Mauritius it mostly takes the form of in-store promotions, screens and sponsored listings on local e-commerce and delivery platforms. Week 16 (e-commerce) returns to this topic.

> **Tip:** when an agency proposes CTV or DOOH, ask how they will prove it worked: a brand lift study, a geographic test (some regions with ads, some without) or a rise in branded search during the campaign.

PART E

Measure & protect

Metrics and formulas, brand lift, viewability, invalid traffic, brand safety and optimisation

SECTION 24

Awareness metrics and formulas

Display and video platforms report dozens of metrics. These are the ones that matter for awareness campaigns, with their formulas.

How to measure an awareness campaign

Climb the ladder: delivery numbers alone don't prove impact



Metric	Formula / definition	What it tells you
Impressions	Number of times the ad was shown	Delivery volume
CPM	cost ÷ impressions × 1,000	Price of 1,000 impressions
Viewable impressions	Impressions that met the viewability standard (Section 26)	Real chance to be seen
Viewability rate	viewable impressions ÷ measurable impressions × 100	Quality of placements
vCPM	cost ÷ viewable impressions × 1,000	Price of 1,000 viewable impressions
Views (YouTube)	Skippable: 30 seconds or the full ad if shorter, or an interaction	Real interest in the video
View rate	views ÷ impressions × 100	How engaging the video is
CPV	cost ÷ views	Price of one view
Video played to 25/50/75/100%	Share of impressions watched to each point	Where people stop watching
Unique reach	Number of different people (or users) who saw the ad	Size of audience reached
Average frequency	impressions ÷ unique reach	How often each person saw it
CTR	clicks ÷ impressions × 100	Secondary for awareness
Earned actions	Subscriptions, likes, shares, extra views after an ad	Organic effect of the ad on YouTube

Worked example

Data from a 4-week campaign (illustrative)	Calculation	Result
Cost Rs 30,000, impressions 300,000	30,000 ÷ 300,000 × 1,000	CPM = Rs 100
Views 75,000	75,000 ÷ 300,000 × 100	View rate = 25%
Cost Rs 30,000, views 75,000	30,000 ÷ 75,000	CPV = Rs 0.40
Unique reach 100,000	300,000 ÷ 100,000	Average frequency = 3
Viewable 210,000 of 280,000 measurable	210,000 ÷ 280,000 × 100	Viewability = 75%

SECTION 25

Brand lift, view-through and incrementality

Awareness campaigns must prove that they changed something in people’s minds or behaviour. Clicks are a poor guide: many people see an ad, don’t click, and act later.

Click-through vs view-through

Type	Definition	Use
Click-through conversion	Someone clicks the ad, then converts	Clear link, but undercounts awareness impact
View-through conversion	Someone sees the ad (impression) without clicking, then converts within a set window	Shows delayed impact; can overcount people who would have converted anyway
Engaged-view conversion (YouTube)	Someone watches at least 10 seconds of a skippable ad (or all of it if shorter), does not click, and converts later	Fairer view of video influence

> View-through numbers are attractive in reports but must be treated with care: the person may have converted anyway. Use short windows, compare with a control group, and present view-through separately from click-through conversions.

Brand lift studies

A brand lift study measures the change in how people think about a brand by comparing two groups: people who saw the ad (exposed) and similar people who did not (control). Both groups answer a short survey, for example on YouTube. The difference between the groups is the **lift**.

Metric	Survey question (example)
Ad recall	"Which of these brands have you seen an online video ad for recently?"
Brand awareness	"Which of these guesthouses have you heard of?"
Consideration	"Which of these would you consider for your next holiday?"
Favourability	"What is your opinion of the following brands?"

Google and Meta offer brand lift studies inside their ad platforms, but they usually require a minimum budget and eligibility that small local campaigns may not reach. Check the current requirements with the platform.

Low-budget ways to measure lift

- **Branded search:** track searches for your brand name in Google Search Console and Google Trends before, during and after (Week 3).
- **Direct and organic traffic** in GA4 (Week 2): more people typing your URL or searching your name.
- **"How did you hear about us?"** on forms, at the till and in WhatsApp conversations.
- **Geo test:** run the campaign in some regions (or source countries) and not in others, then compare enquiries.
- **Before/after mini-survey** of followers or customers (a simple Google Form).

Incrementality

Incrementality asks: what happened **because of** the ads that would not have happened without them? Tests with a control group (brand lift, conversion lift, geo tests) are the most reliable way to answer. Week 11 (advanced analytics) and Week 12 (performance and ROAS) go deeper into attribution and incrementality.

SECTION 26

Viewability, invalid traffic and brand safety

Not every impression you pay for has value. Some ads are never on screen, some are seen by bots, and some appear next to content that can damage the brand. Three quality checks protect your budget and reputation.

Viewability

An impression is **viewable** when the ad had a real chance to be seen. The industry standard used by Google's Active View follows the Media Rating Council (MRC) definition:

Ad type	Viewable when
Display	At least 50% of the ad's area is on screen for at least 1 continuous second (30% for very large ads of 242,500 pixels or more)
Video	At least 50% of the ad's area is on screen while the video plays for at least 2 continuous seconds

Improve viewability by excluding placements with low viewability, preferring formats that sit in the main content (in-stream video, in-feed), and buying on a viewable CPM (vCPM) basis where the platform allows it.

Invalid traffic (IVT)

Invalid traffic means impressions and clicks that do not come from real, interested people: bots, crawlers, accidental clicks, click farms or fraud. The industry separates **general invalid traffic** (GIVT: known bots and data centres, easy to filter) from **sophisticated invalid traffic** (SIVT: fraud designed to look human, harder to detect).

- Google filters invalid traffic automatically and does not charge for clicks and impressions it detects as invalid; you can see invalid clicks in the columns of your Google Ads reports.
- Warning signs: very high CTR with zero engagement on the site, traffic from unexpected countries, many clicks from one app, sessions of 0 seconds in GA4.
- Exclude suspicious apps and sites, and keep content and placement exclusions up to date.

Brand safety and brand suitability

Concept	Meaning	How to manage it
Brand safety	Avoid content that no advertiser wants: illegal content, hate, violence, adult content	Platform policies, verification tools, exclusion lists
Brand suitability	Avoid content that is legal but not right for your brand (e.g. news about accidents for an airline)	Inventory type (Expanded, Standard, Limited), excluded topics and keywords
Verification	Independent measurement of viewability, fraud and safety	IAS, DoubleVerify (large advertisers)

In Mauritius: think about local sensitivities: elections, religious events, cyclones and floods, and tragic news in a small country where everybody knows someone affected. Pause or adjust campaigns quickly when a serious event happens, and avoid humour that could be misread.

SECTION 27

Optimising and reporting awareness campaigns

Awareness campaigns are optimised differently from search or conversion campaigns. You improve reach quality, attention and memory, not only cost per click.

Optimisation routine

When	What to check	Typical actions
Days 1–3	Delivery, spend pace, disapproved ads	Fix policy issues; check budget is spending
Week 1	Placements, viewability, view rate per ad	Exclude poor placements; pause clearly weak creatives
Week 2	Reach, frequency, audience and device performance	Shift budget to better audiences; adjust frequency settings
Week 3–4	Creative fatigue (falling view rate), brand searches	Refresh creative; prepare the report and learnings

Levers you can pull

- **Creative:** the biggest lever. Test new hooks in the first 5 seconds; shorten long videos; add captions.
- **Audience:** broaden if reach is too small or CPM too high; narrow if view rate is poor.
- **Placements:** exclude low-quality inventory; add strong placements.
- **Formats:** add bumpers to lower CPM and raise frequency; add Shorts for younger audiences.
- **Bids and budget:** raise target CPM if you are not winning enough impressions; move budget to the best campaign.

A one-page awareness report

Section	Content
1. Summary	Objective, what happened, three key learnings
2. Delivery	Spend, impressions, CPM, viewability, vs plan
3. Reach and frequency	Unique reach, average frequency, by channel
4. Attention	View rate, CPV, video quartiles, best and worst creative
5. Impact	Brand searches, direct traffic, enquiries, lift results
6. Next steps	What to keep, change and stop

Build the report in Data Studio (Week 2) with Google Ads and GA4 data, or in a simple slide. Week 18 shows how to tell the story behind the numbers.

PART F

Put it to work

A case study, your Awareness Campaign plan, templates and checklists

SECTION 28

Case study: a guesthouse awareness campaign

"Lagon Bleu" is a fictional but realistic 12-room guesthouse in Trou aux Biches. It has good reviews, but few people outside its past guests know it. Search ads (Week 6) bring bookings, but branded searches are low and the cost per booking keeps rising. The owner agrees to test awareness advertising in the low season.

1. Objective and KPIs

Element	Decision
Business goal	Fill more rooms in the low season (May–September) with direct bookings
Awareness objective	Reach 80,000 people in Réunion and Mauritius at least 3 times in 4 weeks
Attention KPIs	View rate above 25% on skippable ads; viewability above 70%
Impact KPIs	+25% branded searches and +20% direct booking enquiries vs the previous 4 weeks
Budget	Rs 60,000 for 4 weeks (illustrative)

2. Audiences and placements

- **Réunion (60% of budget):** ages 28–60, French language; affinity "beach lovers" and "travel buffs"; custom segment from searches such as "séjour île Maurice", "guesthouse Maurice"; lookalike of past guests in Demand Gen.
- **Mauritius (40%):** ages 25–55, couples and families, for weekend staycations; YouTube cooking, music and travel content in Kreol and French.
- **Exclusions:** account-level list of mobile game apps and children’s channels; Standard inventory; tragedy and conflict excluded.
- **Existing customers excluded** from awareness ad groups (customer list uploaded with consent).

3. Media plan

Campaign	Format	Budget	Goal
Video reach – efficient reach	6 s bumper + 20 s skippable (3 variations)	Rs 30,000	Reach and frequency
Demand Gen (YouTube + Discover + Display)	Image and video ads, 3 variations	Rs 20,000	Visits to the website
Local news site (direct, Mauritius)	Homepage banner, 1 week	Rs 10,000	Local credibility

4. Creative

One idea, "Your quiet corner of the lagoon", in three variations: A (emotion: a morning at the guesthouse, filmed on a phone with a gimbal), B (proof: three reasons guests come back, with the real review score), C (offer: 7 nights for the price of 6 in the low season). Each variation exists as a 6-second bumper, a 20-second horizontal video, a vertical 9:16 version and three image ratios.

5. Results after 4 weeks (illustrative)

KPI	Target	Result
Impressions (Google campaigns)	–	520,000
CPM (Google campaigns, Rs 50,000 spent)	Under Rs 120	Rs 96
Unique reach	80,000	140,000
Average frequency (4 weeks)	3+	3.7
View rate (skippable)	25%	31% (variation A 36%, B 30%, C 24%)
Viewability (display)	70%	74% after excluding apps in week 1
Branded searches (Search Console)	+25%	+38%
Direct booking enquiries	+20%	+27%

What made the difference: the emotional variation A had the best view rate and was given more budget in week 2. Excluding game apps in week 1 raised viewability. The Réunion audience produced most of the extra branded searches. The local news banner brought few clicks but several guests mentioned it at check-in.

> **The lesson:** the campaign was judged on reach, attention and branded search, as agreed before launch. It was not stopped after week 1 for "low clicks", and the search campaigns benefited in the following months from more people searching for the brand.

SECTION 29

Exercises and your Awareness Campaign

Your Week 9 deliverable is an **Awareness Campaign** plan: a display and video campaign plan with 3 creative variations and a targeting strategy. Work on a real business (your own, your employer's or one you know well). You do not need to spend money: this is a plan you could launch.

Exercise A · Objective, audience and placements (45 min)

Write one SMART awareness objective and the KPI table (Section 4). Translate your persona into a targeting strategy with core, expansion and warm layers (Section 5), and list the channels, placements and exclusions you will use (Sections 6 and 17).

Exercise B · Design the display and video ads (60 min)

Using the ABCDs (Section 8), create 3 creative variations around one idea. For each one: a storyboard for a 15–30-second video (5 frames with what is shown, said and written on screen), a 6-second bumper script, and a display ad (headlines, long headline, description, image idea) that respects the specifications in Section 11. Canva is enough for mock-ups.

Exercise C · Set up the audience segments (30 min)

In a Google Ads account (your own, a client's with permission, or by following the steps without publishing), build one custom segment and note its estimated size (Section 16). Screenshot the segment and the audience settings of one ad group.

Deliverable: the Awareness Campaign plan

Part	Content
1. Business and objective	Business summary, SMART awareness objective, KPI table with targets
2. Audience and targeting strategy	Persona, segments (core, expansion, warm), locations, languages, exclusions
3. Channels and placements	Chosen campaign types and formats, placement plan, brand-suitability settings
4. Budget, reach and frequency	Budget split, estimated CPM, reach and frequency, flighting calendar
5. Three creative variations	Storyboards, bumper scripts and display ads for variations A, B and C
6. Measurement	Metrics, tracking (UTM, GA4 key events), brand lift method, report outline
7. Risks and optimisation	What you will check each week and what you will change

Submit the plan (Google Doc, Slides or PDF link, 6–10 pages) on the learning platform, Module 9 exercises.

TEMPLATES

Copy-and-use templates

Awareness campaign plan on one page

Item	Your plan
Business / brand	
SMART objective	
Main audience (persona)	
Locations and languages	
Campaign types and formats	
Budget and dates	
Estimated CPM, reach, frequency	
Creative idea (one line)	
Success metrics and targets	

Targeting strategy

Layer	Segments / content	Locations	Exclusions	Budget %
Core				
Expansion				
Warm				
Contextual (topics, placements)				

Creative variations

	Variation A	Variation B	Variation C
Angle (emotion / proof / offer)			
Hook (first 5 seconds)			
Key message			
Bumper script (6 s)			
Display headline (30 characters)			
Call to action			

Video storyboard (one per variation)

Frame	Seconds	What we see	What we hear	Text on screen
1 · Hook	0–5			
2				
3				
4 · Brand				
5 · Call to action				

SECTION 30

Checklists and glossary

Awareness campaign launch checklist

- ☐ SMART awareness objective and KPI targets agreed with the client before launch
- ☐ Audiences built: core, expansion, warm (and existing customers excluded if needed)
- ☐ Locations and languages match the audience (source markets for tourism)
- ☐ Videos uploaded to YouTube; channel linked to Google Ads
- ☐ 3 creative variations, each in bumper, 15–30 s, vertical and image versions
- ☐ Responsive display assets in 1.91:1, 1:1 and 4:5; logos; headlines within limits
- ☐ Brand suitability set (inventory type, excluded topics); account exclusion list applied
- ☐ Frequency approach defined (target frequency, caps or campaign groups)
- ☐ UTM tags on every final URL; GA4 key events working (Week 2)
- ☐ Baseline recorded: branded searches, direct traffic, enquiries for the previous 4 weeks
- ☐ Weekly optimisation slot in the diary; report template ready

Mistakes to avoid

Mistake	Do this instead
Judging awareness campaigns on CTR and cost per click	Agree reach, attention and brand-search KPIs before launch
A 60-second TV ad with the logo only at the end	Brand in the first 5 seconds; cut-downs for each format
No captions on videos	Subtitles and on-screen text: many people watch muted
Letting ads run on any app or channel	Content exclusions, placement checks, exclusion lists
Budget spread over too many audiences	Fewer, larger ad groups so each reaches people several times
Showing the same ad 20 times a week	Frequency target or caps; refresh creative
Stopping after one week	Allow the learning period and a full flight (3–4 weeks)
Reporting view-through conversions as if they were clicks	Report them separately; use tests and brand lift

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Ad exchange	Marketplace where buyers and sellers of ad impressions meet in auctions
Ad server	Technology that stores ads, decides which to show and counts them
Bumper ad	Non-skippable YouTube video ad of up to 6 seconds
CDP / DMP	Customer data platform (known customers) / data management platform (mostly anonymous audiences)
Contextual targeting	Targeting the content (topic, keywords, placement) rather than the person
CPM / vCPM	Cost per 1,000 impressions / per 1,000 viewable impressions
CPV	Cost per view
CTV / OTT	Connected TV (internet TV screens) / over-the-top streaming
Deal ID	Code linking a private programmatic deal to a buyer
Demand Gen	Google campaign type for YouTube, Discover, Gmail and the Display Network
DOOH	Digital out-of-home: digital screens in public places
DSP / SSP	Demand-side platform (buyers) / supply-side platform (publishers)
Frequency	Average number of times each person saw the ad
IVT (GIVT / SIVT)	Invalid traffic (general / sophisticated)
Managed placement	A specific site, app, channel or video you choose to target
PMP	Private marketplace: invitation-only programmatic auction
Programmatic guaranteed	Reserved inventory at a fixed price, bought through automation
Reach	Number of unique people who saw the ad
RTB	Real-time bidding: auctions for each impression as a page loads
View rate	Views ÷ impressions
Viewability	Whether an ad had a real chance to be seen (50% of pixels for 1 s display, 2 s video)
View-through conversion	Conversion after seeing, but not clicking, an ad
Walled garden	Platform that controls its own ads, data and measurement (Google, Meta, TikTok, Amazon)